

- Nwagu Aneke script** – Igbo

- Vai** – Vai
- Woleaian** – **Woleaian** (a likely syllabary)
- Yi** (modern) – various **Yi/Lolo languages**

Semi-syllabaries [edit]

In most of these systems, some consonant-vowel combinations are written as syllables, but others are written as consonant plus vowel. In the case of Old Persian, all vowels were written regardless, so it was *effectively* a true alphabet despite its syllabic component. In Japanese a similar system plays a minor role in foreign borrowings; for example, [tu] is written [to]+[u], and [ti] as [te]+[i]. Paleohispanic **semi-syllabaries** behaved as a **syllabary** for the **stop consonants** and as an **alphabet** for the rest of consonants and vowels.

The Tartessian or Southwestern script is typologically intermediate between a pure alphabet and the Paleohispanic full semi-syllabaries. Although the letter used to write a stop consonant was determined by the following vowel, as in a full **semi-syllabary**, the following vowel was also written, as in an alphabet. Some scholars treat Tartessian as a redundant semi-syllabary, others treat it as a redundant alphabet. Other scripts, such as Bopomofo, are semi-syllabic in a different sense: they transcribe half syllables. That is, they have letters for **syllable onsets** and **rimes** (*kan* = "*k-an*") rather than for consonants and vowels (*kan* = "*k-a-n*").

Consonant-vowel semi-syllabaries [edit]

- Bamum script** – **Bamum** (a defective syllabary, with alphabetic principles used to fill the gaps)
- Eskayan** – **Bohol, Philippines** (a syllabary apparently based on an alphabet; some alphabetic characteristics remain)
- Linear Elamite** – **Elamite language**
- Paleohispanic semi-syllabaries** – **Paleo-Hispanic languages**
 - Celtiberian script** – **Celtiberian language**
 - Northeastern Iberian script** – **Iberian language**
 - Southeastern Iberian script** – **Iberian language**
 - Southwest Paleohispanic script** – **Tartessian**
- Old Persian cuneiform** – **Old Persian**

Onset-rime semi-syllabaries [edit]

- Bopomofo** – phonetic script for different **varieties of Chinese**.
- Khom script** – **Bahnaric languages**, including **Alak** and **Jru'**.
- Quốc Âm Tân Tự** – **Vietnamese**

Segmental systems [edit]

A **segmental script** has **graphemes** which represent the **phonemes** (basic unit of sound) of a language.

Note that there need not be (and rarely is) a one-to-one correspondence between the graphemes of the script and the phonemes of a language. A phoneme may be represented only by some combination or string of graphemes, the same phoneme may be represented by more than one distinct grapheme, the same grapheme may stand for more than one phoneme, or some combination of all of the above.

Segmental scripts may be further divided according to the types of phonemes they typically record:

Abjads [edit]

An **abjad** is a segmental script containing symbols for **consonants** only, or where vowels are *optionally* written with **diacritics** ("pointing") or only written word-initially.

- Ancient North Arabian** – **Dadanitic**, **Dumaitic**, **Hasaitic**, **Hismaic**, **Safaitic**, **Taymanitic**, and **Thamudic**
- Ancient South Arabian** – **Old South Arabian languages** including **Himyaritic**, **Hadhramautic**, **Minaean**, **Sabaean** and **Qatabanic**; also the Ethiopic language **Ge'ez**.
- Libyco-Berber** –**Berber languages**
- Aramaic**, including **Khwarezmian** (AKA **Chorasmian**), **Elymaic**, **Palmyrene**, and **Hatran**
- Arabic** – **Arabic**, **Azeri**, **Bengali** (historical occasion), **Chittagonian** (historical occasion), **Punjabi**, **Baluchi**, **Kashmiri**, **Pashto**, **Persian**, **Kurdish** (vowels *obligatory*), **Sindhi**, **Uighur** (vowels *obligatory*), **Urdu**, **Malay** (as **Jawi**) and many other languages spoken in **Africa** and **Western**, **Central**, and **Southeast Asia**,
- Hebrew** – **Hebrew** and other **Jewish languages**
- Manichaean script**
- Nabataean** – the **Nabataeans** of **Petra**
- Pahlavi script** – **Middle Persian**
 - Parthian**
 - Psalter**
- Phoenician** – **Phoenician** and other **Canaanite** languages
- Proto-Canaanite** and **Proto-Sinaitic** – **Bronze Age Canaanites**.
- Sogdian** –**Sogdian language**
- Samaritan (Old Hebrew)** – **Aramaic**, **Arabic**, and **Hebrew**
- Syriac** – **Classical Syriac**, **Sureth**, **Turoyo** and other **Neo-Aramaic dialects**
- Tifinagh** – **Tuareg**
- Ugaritic** – **Ugaritic**, **Hurrian**

True alphabets [edit]

A true **alphabet** contains separate letters (not **diacritic** marks) for both **consonants** and **vowels**.

Linear nonfeatural alphabets [edit]

Linear alphabets are composed of lines on a surface, such as ink on paper.

- Adlam** – **Fula**
- Alifuru** – **Bahasa tanah** languages
- Armenian** – **Armenian**
- Ariyaka script** – **Pali**, **Isan**, **Lao**
- Avestan** – **Avestan**
- Avoiuli** – **Raga**
- Borama** – **Somali**
- Carian** – **Carian**
- Caucasian Albanian** – **Caucasian Albanian**
- Coorgi–Cox alphabet** – **Kodava**
- Coptic** – **Egyptian**
- Cyrillic** – **Eastern South Slavic languages** (**Bulgarian** and **Macedonian**), the Western **South Slavic Serbian**, **Eastern Slavic languages** (**Belarusian**, **Russian**, **Ukrainian**), the other **languages of Russia**, **Kazakh language**, **Kyrgyz language**, **Tajik language**, **Mongolian language**. **Azerbaijan**, **Turkmenistan**, and **Uzbekistan** are changing to the Latin alphabet but still have considerable use of Cyrillic. See **Languages using Cyrillic**.
- Deseret alphabet** – proposed for English but never adopted
- Eclectic shorthand** – **English**
- Elbasan** – **Albanian**
- Fraser** – **Lisu**
- Gabelsberger shorthand** – **German**
- Garay** – **Wolof** and **Mandinka**
- Georgian** – **Georgian** and other **Kartvelian languages**
- Gjirokastër** (also called Veso Bey) – **Albanian**
- Glagolitic** – **Old Church Slavonic**
- Gothic** – **Gothic**
- Greek** – **Greek**, historically a variety of **other languages**
- Hanifi** – **Rohingya**
- International Phonetic Alphabet**
- Kaddare** – **Somali**
- Latin** AKA **Roman** – originally **Latin language**; most current western and central **European languages**, **Turkic languages**, **sub-Saharan African languages**, **indigenous languages of the Americas**, languages of **maritime Southeast Asia** and **languages of Oceania** use developments of it. Languages using a non-Latin writing system are generally also equipped with **Romanization** for **transliteration** or secondary use.
- Lycian** – **Lycian**
- Lydian** – **Lydian**
- Manchu** – **Manchu**
- Mandaic** – **Mandaic** dialect of **Aramaic**
- Medefaidrin** – also called Oberi Okaimɛ; used for the religious language of the same name



- [Mongolian](#) – [Mongolian](#)
- [Mundari Bani](#) – [Mundari](#)
- [Mru script](#) – [Mru](#)
- [Neo-Tifinagh](#) – [Tamazight](#)
- [Nyiakeng Puachue Hmong](#) – [Hmong](#)
- [N'Ko](#) – [Maninka language](#), [Bambara](#), [Dyula language](#)
- [Oduduwa script](#) – [Yoruba](#)
- [Ogham](#) – [Gaelic](#), [Britannic](#), [Pictish](#)
- [Ol Chiki](#) ^{AKA Ol Cemet' or Ol Chemet'} – [Santali](#)
- [Old Hungarian](#) (in Hungarian *magyar rovásírás* or *székely-magyar rovásírás*) – [Hungarian](#)
- [Old Italic](#) – a family of connected alphabets for the [Etruscan](#), [Oscan](#), [Umbrian](#), [Messapian](#), [South Picene](#), [Raetic](#), [Venetic](#), [Lepontic](#), [Camunic languages](#)
- [Old Permic](#) (also called *Abur*) – [Komi](#)
- [Old Turkic](#) – [Old Turkic](#)
- [Old Uyghur](#) – [Old Uyghur](#)
- [Ol Onal](#) – [Bhumij Language](#)
- [Osmanya](#) – [Somali](#)
- [Pau Cin Hau alphabetic script](#) – [Paite](#) and other [Northeastern Kuki-Chin languages](#)
- [Runes](#) – [Germanic languages](#)
- [Sayaboury](#) (also called Eebee Hmong or *Ntawv Puaṡ Txwm*) – [Hmong Daw](#)
- [Sorang Sompeng](#) – [Sora](#)
- [Tai Lue](#) – [Lue](#)
- [Tangsa](#) – [Tangsa language](#)
- [Todhri](#) – [Albanian](#)
- [Tolong Siki](#) – [Kurukh](#)
- [Toto](#) – [Toto](#)
- [Unifon](#) – proposed for English, never adopted
- [Vah](#) – [Bassa](#)
- [Vellara](#) – [Albanian](#)
- [Vithkuqi](#) ^{AKA Beitha Kukju} – [Albanian](#)
- [Wancho](#) – [Wancho](#)
- [Yezidi](#) – [Kurmanji](#)
- [Zaghawa](#) – [Zaghawa](#)
- [Zoulai](#) – [Zou](#) (also has alphasyllabic characteristics)

Featural linear alphabets [[edit](#)]

A **featural script** has elements that indicate the components of articulation, such as [bilabial consonants](#), [fricatives](#), or [back vowels](#). Scripts differ in how many features they indicate.

- [ASL-phabet](#)
- [Ditema tsa Dinoko](#) ^{AKA IsiBheqe SoHlamvu} for [Southern Bantu languages](#)
- [Duployan Shorthand](#)
- [Gregg Shorthand](#)
- [Hangul](#) – [Korean](#)
- [Osage](#) – [Osage](#)
- [Shavian alphabet](#) – proposed for English, never adopted
- [SignWriting](#) and its descendants [si5s](#) and [ASLwrite](#) for [sign languages](#)
- [Stokoe notation](#) for [American Sign Language](#), and its descendant, the [Hamburg Notation System](#) or HamNoSys
- [Tengwar](#) (a fictional script)
- [Visible Speech](#) (a phonetic script)

Linear alphabets arranged into syllabic blocks [[edit](#)]

- [Hangul](#) – [Korean](#)
- [Great Lakes Algonquian syllabics](#) – [Fox](#), [Potawatomi](#), [Ho-Chunk](#), [Ojibwe](#)
- [IsiBheqe SoHlamvu](#) – [Southern Bantu languages](#)
- [ʼPhags-pa script](#) – [Mongolian](#), [Chinese](#), [Persian](#), [Sanskrit](#)

Manual alphabets [[edit](#)]

Manual alphabets are frequently found as parts of [sign languages](#). They are not used for writing *per se*, but for spelling out words while signing.

- [American manual alphabet](#) (used with slight modification in [Hong Kong](#), [Malaysia](#), [Paraguay](#), [Philippines](#), [Singapore](#), [Taiwan](#), [Thailand](#))
- [British manual alphabet](#) (used in some of the [Commonwealth of Nations](#), such as [Australia](#) and [New Zealand](#))
- [Catalan manual alphabet](#)
- [Chilean manual alphabet](#)
- [Chinese manual alphabet](#)
- [Dutch manual alphabet](#)
- [Ethiopian manual alphabet](#) (an abugida)
- [French manual alphabet](#)
- [Greek manual alphabet](#)
- [Icelandic manual alphabet](#) (also used in [Denmark](#))
- [Indian manual alphabet](#) (a true alphabet?; used in [Devanagari](#) and [Gujarati](#) areas)
- [International manual alphabet](#) (used in [Germany](#), [Austria](#), [Norway](#), [Finland](#))
- [Iranian manual alphabet](#) (an abjad; also used in [Egypt](#))
- [Israeli manual alphabet](#) (an abjad)
- [Italian manual alphabet](#)
- [Korean manual alphabet](#)
- [Latin American manual alphabets](#)
- [Polish manual alphabet](#)
- [Portuguese manual alphabet](#)
- [Romanian manual alphabet](#)
- [Russian manual alphabet](#) (also used in [Bulgaria](#) and ex-[Soviet](#) states)
- [Spanish manual alphabet](#) ([Madrid](#))
- [Swedish manual alphabet](#)
- [Yugoslav manual alphabet](#)

Other non-linear alphabets [[edit](#)]

These are other alphabets composed of something other than lines on a surface.

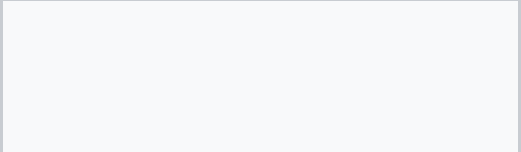
- [Braille \(Unified\)](#) – an embossed alphabet for the visually impaired, used with some extra letters to transcribe the Latin, Cyrillic, Greek, Hebrew, and Arabic alphabets, as well as Chinese
- [Braille \(Korean\)](#)
- [Braille \(American\)](#) (defunct)
- [New York Point](#) – a defunct alternative to Braille
- [International maritime signal flags](#) (both alphabetic and ideographic)
- [Morse code \(International\)](#) – a [trinary](#) code of dashes, dots, and silence, whether transmitted by electricity, light, or sound) representing characters in the Latin alphabet.
- [American Morse code](#) (defunct)
- [Optical telegraphy](#) (defunct)
- [Flag semaphore](#) – (made by moving hand-held flags)

Abugidas [[edit](#)]

An **abugida**, or *alphasyllabary*, is a segmental script in which [vowel](#) sounds are denoted by [diacritical marks](#) or other systematic modification of the [consonants](#). Generally, however, if a single letter is understood to have an inherent unwritten vowel, and only vowels other than this are written, then the system is classified as an abugida regardless of whether the vowels look like diacritics or full letters. The vast majority of abugidas are found from India to Southeast Asia and belong historically to the Brāhmī family, however the term is derived from the first characters of the abugida in [Geʿez](#): ጸ (a) ቡ (bu) ኀ (gi) ዳ (da) — (compare with *[alphabet](#)*). Unlike abjads, the diacritical marks and systemic modifications of the consonants are not optional.

Brahmi family [[edit](#)]

- [Ahom](#)
- [Balinese](#)
- [Batak](#) – [Toba](#) and other [Batak languages](#)



• **Baybayin** – Formerly used for **Ilokano**, **Pangasinan**, **Tagalog**, **Bikol languages**, **Visayan languages**, and possibly other **Philippine languages**

- **Bengali** — Bengali, Assamese, Meithei, Bishnupriya Manipuri
- **Bhaiksuki**
- **Brahmi** – Sanskrit, Prakrit
- **Buda** – Old Sundanese and Old Javanese
- **Buhid**
- **Burmese** – Burmese, Karen languages, Mon, and Shan
- **Cham**
- **Chakma**
- **Devanagari** – Hindi, Sanskrit, Marathi, Nepali, and many other languages of northern India
- **Dhives Akuru**
- **Grantha** – Sanskrit
- **Gujarati** – Gujarati, Kutchi, Vasavi, Sanskrit, Avestan
- **Gurmukhi script** – Punjabi
- **Hanuno'o**
- **Javanese**
- **Kaithi**
- **Kannada** – Kannada, Tulu, Konkani, Kodava
- **Kawi**
- **Khema script** – Gurung
- **Khojki**
- **Khudabadi**
- **Khmer**
- **Kirat Rai** *AKA* **Khambu Rai** – Bantawa
- **Kulitan alphabet**
- **Lai Tay** – Tai Yo
- **Lampung**
- **Lao**
- **Leke** – Eastern Pwo, Western Pwo, and Karen
- **Lepcha**
- **Limbu**
- **Lontara'** – Buginese, Makassar, and Mandar
- **Mahajani**
- **Makasar** – Formerly used for **Makassar**
- **Malayalam**
- **Marchen** – Zhang-Zhung
- **Meitei Mayek** – Meitei
- **Modi** – Marathi
- **Multani** – Saraiki
- **Nandinagari** – Sanskrit
- **Naoriya Phulo script** – Meitei
- **New Tai Lue**
- **Odia**
- **Pracalit script** *AKA* **Newa** – Nepal Bhasa, Sanskrit, Pali
- **Pyu** – Pyu
- **Ranjana** – Nepal Bhasa, Sanskrit
- **Rejang**
- **Rencong**
- **Saurashtra**
- **Sharada** – Sanskrit, Kashmiri
- **Siddham** – Sanskrit
- **Sinhala**
- **Sirmauri**
- **Soyombo**
- **Sundanese**
- **Sylheti Nagri** – Sylheti
- **Tagbanwa** – Languages of Palawan
- **Tai Le** *AKA* **Dehong Dai** – Tai Nuea
- **Tai Tham** – Khün, and Northern Thai
- **Tai Viet**
- **Takri**
- **Tamil**
- **Telugu**
- **Thai**
- **Tibetan**
- **Tigalari** – Sanskrit, Tulu
- **Tirhuta** – used to write Maithili
- **Tocharian**
- **Vatteluttu**
- **Zanabazar Square**
- **Zhang zhung** scripts

Other abugidas [[edit](#)]

- **Canadian Aboriginal syllabics** – **Cree syllabics** (for **Cree**), **Inuktitut syllabics** (for **Inuktitut**), **Ojibwe syllabics** (for **Ojibwe**), and various systems for other languages of Canada. Derived scripts with identical operating principles but divergent character repertoires include **Carrier** and **Blackfoot** syllabics.
- **Dham** – Dhimal
- **Ge'ez** – Amharic, Ge'ez, Tigrigna
- **Kharoṣṭhī** – Gandhari, Sanskrit
- **Kurukh Banna** – Kurukh
- **Lontara Bilang-bilang script** – Buginese
- **Mandombe**
- **Masaram Gondi** – Gondi
- **Meroitic** – Meroë
- **Mwangwego** – Chewa and other Bantu languages of Malawi
- **Pitman Shorthand**
- **Pollard script** – Miao
- **Sapalo script** – Oromo
- **Rma script** – Qiang
- **Sunuwar** *AKA* **Jenticha**
- **Thaana** – Dhivehi
- **Tikamuli** – Sunuwar
- **Thomas Natural Shorthand**

Final consonant-diacritic abugidas [[edit](#)]

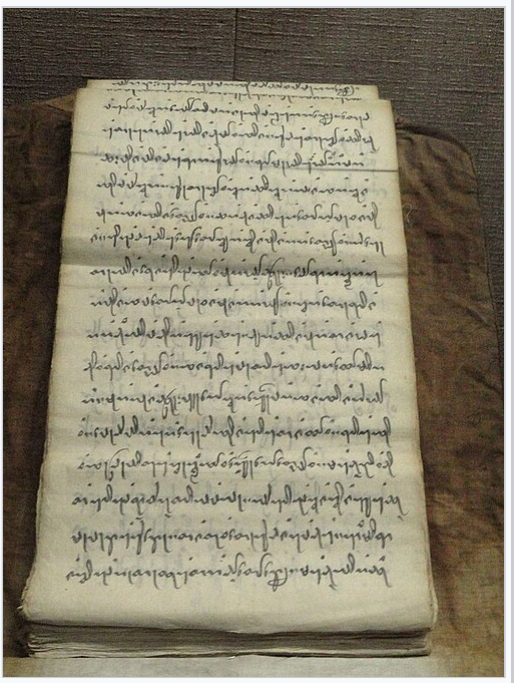
In at least one abugida, not only the vowel but any **syllable-final** consonant is written with a diacritic. That is, if representing [o] with an under-ring, and final [k] with an over-cross, [sok] would be written as ṣ̣̅.

- **Róng** – Lepcha

Vowel-based abugidas [[edit](#)]

In a few abugidas, the vowels are basic, and the consonants secondary. If no consonant is written in Pahawh Hmong, it is understood to be /k/; consonants are written after the vowel they precede in speech. In Japanese Braille, the vowels but not the consonants have independent status, and it is the vowels which are modified when the consonant is y or w.

- **Boyd's Syllabic Shorthand**



A **Palaung** manuscript written in a Brahmic abugida

- Japanese Braille – Japanese
- Pahawh Hmong – Hmong

List of writing systems by adoption [edit]



This section **possibly contains original research**. Please improve it by verifying the claims made and adding inline citations. Statements consisting only of original research should be removed. *(April 2023)* *(Learn how and when to remove this message)*

The following list contains writing systems that are in active use by a population of at least 50,000.

Name of script ↕	Type ↕	Population actively using (in millions) ↕	Languages associated with ↕	Regions using script de facto ↕
Latin Latin	Alphabet	4900+ ^[3] ^[note 2]	Latin ^[note 3] and Romance languages (languages that evolved from Latin: Italian , French , Portuguese , Spanish and Romanian) Germanic languages (English, Dutch, German, Nordic languages)^[note 4] Celtic languages (Welsh, Irish and Scottish Gaelic)^[note 5] Baltic languages (Latvian and Lithuanian) Some Slavic languages (Polish, Czech, Slovak, Croatian, Slovenian) Albanian Uralic languages (Finnish, Estonian and Hungarian) Malayo-Polynesian languages (Malaysian,^[note 6] Indonesian, Filipino, etc.) Turkic languages (Turkish,^[note 7] Azerbaijani, Uzbek, Turkmen) Some Cushitic languages (Somali, Afar, Oromo) Bantu languages (for example: Swahili) Vietnamese (an Austroasiatic language)^[note 8] others	Worldwide
Chinese 汉字 漢字	Logographic	1541 ^[4]	Sinitic languages (Mandarin, Min, Wu, Yue, Jin, Gan, Hakka and others) Japanese (Kanji) Korean (Hanja)^[note 9] Vietnamese (Chu Nom obsolete) Zhuang (Sawndip)	Eastern Asia, Singapore
Arabic العربية	Abjad or Abugida (when diacritics are used)	828 ^[4]	Arabic (a Semitic language) Several Indo-Iranian languages (Persian, Kurdish, Urdu, Punjabi (Shahmukhi in Pakistan), Pashto, Sindhi, Balochi, Kashmiri) Some Turkic languages (Uyghur, Kazakh (in China), Azeri (in Iran)) Malay (in Brunei) others	Afghanistan, Algeria, Bahrain, Brunei, Chad, Comoros, Djibouti, Egypt, Eritrea, Iran, Iraq, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Mauritania, Morocco, Libya, Oman, Pakistan, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Somalia, Sudan, Syria, Tunisia, United Arab Emirates and Yemen
Devanagari देवनागरी	Abugida	480.5	Indo-Aryan languages (Bhojpuri, Hindi, Kashmiri, Marathi, Nepali, Sanskrit and many more) Tibeto-Burman languages (Bodo, Newar, Sherpa)	India, Nepal and Fiji
Cyrillic Кириллица	Alphabet	289 ^[4]	Many Slavic languages (Bulgarian and Macedonian, Russian, Serbian, Belarusian, Ukrainian, others). Non-Slavic languages of the former Soviet Union, such as West- and East Caucasian languages (Abkhaz, Chechen, Avar, others), Uralic languages (Karelian, others), Iranian languages (Ossetic, Tajik, others) and Turkic language (Kyrgyz, Tatar, Azeri (formerly), and others).	Belarus, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Mongolia, Montenegro, North Macedonia, Russia, Serbia, Tajikistan and Ukraine
Bengali বাংলা	Abugida	300	Bengali, Assamese, Meithei, Bishnupriya Manipuri	Bangladesh and India
Kana かな カナ	Syllabary	123	Japanese, Ryukyuan languages, Hachijō, Ainu, Palauan ^[5]	Japan
Telugu తెలుగు	Abugida	83	Telugu	India
Hangul 한글 조선글	Alphabet, featural	81.7	Korean, Cia-Cia (an Austronesian language)	North Korea and South Korea, Indonesia
Tamil தமிழ்	Abugida	78.6	Tamil	India, Sri Lanka, Singapore, Malaysia
Thai ไทย	Abugida	70	Thai	Thailand
Gujarati ગુજરાતી	Abugida	57.1	Gujarati	India
Kannada ಕನ್ನಡ	Abugida	45 ^[note 10]	Kannada (a Dravidian language)	India
Ge'ez ግዕዝ	Abugida	41.85	Amharic, Tigrinya	Ethiopia, Eritrea
Burmese မြန်မာ	Abugida	39 ^[note 11]	Burmese (a Lolo-Burmese language)	Myanmar
Malayalam മലയാളം	Abugida	38	Malayalam	India
Odia ଓଡ଼ିଆ	Abugida	35	Odia	India
Gurmukhi ਗੁਰਮੁਖੀ	Abugida	33.125	Punjabi	India
Sinhala සිංහල	Abugida	16	Sinhalese	Sri Lanka
Khmer ខ្មែរ	Abugida	16	Khmer	Cambodia
Greek Ελληνικά	Alphabet	13.5	Greek	Greece, Cyprus
Hebrew עברית	Abjad, Abugida (when diacritics are used) or Alphabet (when used for Yiddish)	9.3 ^[6]	Hebrew, Yiddish	Israel
Oi Chiki	Alphabet	7.3	Santali	India
Lao ລາວ	Abugida	7	Lao (a Tai language)	Laos
Tibetan བོད་སྐད་	Abugida	6.241	Dzongkha, Tibetan and Sikkimese	China, Bhutan, India
Armenian Հայերեն	Alphabet	5.4	Armenian	Armenia
Mongolian	Alphabet	5.2	Mongolian	Mongolia, China
Georgian	Alphabet	3.7	Georgian, Mingrelian, Laz, Svan	Georgia, Russia, Abkhazia

Unown			<i>Pokémon</i>
Utopian		Utopian	

See also [edit]

- Constructed script (artificial script)
- List of creators of writing systems
- List of ISO 15924 codes
- List of languages by first written accounts
- Unicode
- Writing systems without word boundaries

Notes [edit]

- ↑ This maps shows languages official in the respective countries; if a country has an independent breakaway republic, both languages are shown. Moldova's sole official language is Romanian (Latin-based), but the unrecognized de facto independent republic of Transnistria uses three Cyrillic-based languages: Ukrainian, Russian, and Moldovan. Georgia's official languages are Georgian and Abkhazian (in Autonomous Republic of Abkhazia), the sparsely recognized de facto independent republics of Abkhazia and South Ossetia use Cyrillic-based languages: Both republics use Russian. Additionally, Abkhazia also uses Abkhaz, and South Ossetia uses Ossetian. Additionally, Serbia's sole official language is Cyrillic Serbian, but within the country, Latin script for Serbian is also widely used.
- ↑ Difficult to determine, as it is used to write a very large number of languages with varying literacy rates among them.
- ↑ alphabet originally created to this language
- ↑ replaced the *runic alphabet*
- ↑ replaced the *Ogham*
- ↑ replaced the *Arabic alphabet*
- ↑ replaced the *Arabic script*
- ↑ replaced the *Chu Nom*
- ↑ *Hanja* is increasingly being phased out in South Korea. It is mainly used in official documents, newspapers, books, and signs to identify Chinese roots to Korean words.
- ↑ Based on 46 million speakers of *Kannada*, *Tulu*, *Konkani*, *Kodava*, *Badaga* in a state with a 75.6 literacy rate. url=http://updateox.com/india/26-populated-cities-karnataka-population-sex-ratio-literacy
- ↑ Based on 42 million speakers of *Burmese* in a country (*Myanmar*) with a 92% *literacy rate*.

References [edit]

- ↑ Halliday, M.A.K., *Spoken and written language*, Deakin University Press, 1985, p.19
- ↑ Clemmensen, Mikkel Bøg; Helmke, Christophe (2023-06-08). *Western Mesoamerican Calendars and Writing Systems: Proceedings of the Copenhagen Roundtable*. Archaeopress Publishing Ltd. ISBN 978-1-80327-486-7.
- ↑ Vaughan, Don (23 Nov 2020). "The World's 5 Most Commonly Used Writing Systems". *Britannica*. Retrieved 2023-04-13.
- ↑ ***a b c d e*** Population using script where it is official, according to 100% alphabetization.
- ↑ Thomas E. McAuley, *Language change in East Asia*, 2001:90
- ↑ "Hebrew". *Ethnologue: Languages of the World*. SIL International. 2019-09-27. Archived from the original on 2019-09-27. Retrieved 2022-10-08.

External links [edit]

- Ancient Scripts: Home**: (Site with some introduction to different writing systems and group them into *origins*/*types*/*families*/*regions*/*timeline*/*A to Z*)
- Michael Everson's *Alphabets of Europe*
- The World's Writing Systems*, catalogue of 294 writing systems, each with a typographic reference glyph and Unicode status
- Deseret Alphabet
- ScriptSource – a dynamic, collaborative reference to the writing systems of the world

V · T · E	Types of writing systems	[show]
V · T · E	Writing systems	[hide]
	Index of language articles	
Overview	Language · History of writing · History of the alphabet · Graphemes · Scripts in Unicode	
Lists	Writing systems · Languages by writing system / by first written account · Ancient languages corpuses by size · Undeciphered writing systems · Creators of writing systems	
Types	Abjads · Abugidas · Alphabets · Featural · Ideogrammic · Logographic · Numeral · Phonogrammic · Pictographic · Semi-syllabaries · Shorthand · Syllabaries	
Current examples	Arabic · Canadian syllabics · Chinese · Devanagari · Hangul · Kana · Latin · Mongolian	
Related topics	In Africa · In Southeast Asia	
	Portal: Languages	
Categories: Lists of writing systems Encodings		

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